

Portable SSD

We've covered SSDs in detail in the storage section so we won't be going into all that detail again. SSDs are pretty new on the market even though they have been around for 3-4 years so they aren't economical in any sense. A 240 GB portable SSD costs around ₹.13,000 -14,000, you can get over 8 TB of space in portable hard drives for the same price. However, it is the ridiculous transfer speeds that these drives offer which makes customers buy them. Like flash drives they too are pretty light and have no moving parts which makes them a heck lot durable than portable hard drives.

Interface

Having a fast technology behind a type of portable storage requires an equally fast or faster interface for data transfer.

USB

Universal Serial Bus has been around for more than a decade and we have seen two major revisions to the USB protocol and both are in popular use around the world. The USB 2.0, USB 3.0 interface and the recently introduced USB 3.1 interface are what the majority of storage devices use. Each



revision is backwards compatible, so you can use your new USB 3.0 flash drive on your old computer that only has USB 2.0 ports, of course you'll not get the speed that USB 3.0 support but data can be transferred. Similarly, USB 3.0 ports can accept all previous generation USB devices. The respective speeds are listed below:

USB 2.0 – 480 Mbit/s

USB 3.0 – 5 Gbit/s

USB 3.1 – 10 Gbit/s

With each revision the power that can be supplied along each port has increased tremendously (USB 3.1 can supply 100W), what this means for portable drives is that the ones that needed external power would no longer need them. This does not mean that you can take your current hard drives and hook it up to a USB 3.1 port and expect it to function without external power. Your drive must be designed using USB 3.1 specifications, just being backwards compatible only helps with the data transfer.